LIQUOR TRENDS
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SATURDAY



Season Special · Halloween weekend — how each district should prepare

First Saturday Halloween Since COVID

First Saturday in 2 years

Streets are managed and retail shelves have dropped it — is your district inside Seoul's 14 managed zones or outside? What 25 bars actually prepared.

01 **Decision table — inside/outside 14 zones × entry-type/table-type**
Find your bar's cell first

02 **What 25 bars prepared — 12 ran costume perks**
Item giveaway 5 · Contest 4 · % discount 1

03 **Menu · interior · operation three angles + checklist**
Just the drink color, just one photo spot, Fri+Sat only

First Saturday Halloween Since COVID

10/31 falls on a Saturday for the first time since 2020. That year wasn't normal trading. **Halloween now overlaps the weekend bar peak.**

10.31

SAT

Previous Saturdays: 2020·2015

2020 wasn't normal trading due to COVID

+12%

Insta Oct Halloween mentions vs beer

2025 vs 2024. Absolute +48%, control volatile so ±10%p margin

0 places

Big-3 dept-store Halloween promos (2025)

Hypermarts dropped the Halloween name; among CVS, only CU ran an online event

ONE LINE

The Halloween that left retail shelves moved to bars and theme parks. This year it's a Saturday — finish prep before Friday.

※ Seoul designates crowd-density zones during Halloween week (10/24–11/2) — 14 zones in 2025. Whether your district is inside or outside is this issue's first question (p.03).

Sources: Calendar (10/31 weekday 2015·2020·2026 Sat) / Sometrend Instagram monthly mentions, collected 2026.10.18 / Ajeu 2025.10.19 / Seoul City 2025.10.24 · Seoul Economy 2025.10.29.

CHECK · DECISION TABLE

Where is your bar?

Two axes. Whether your district is **inside Seoul's 14 managed zones**, and whether you **admit guests at the door** or **seat them at tables**. Same frame as the Chuseok issue (W35).

	Entry-type ticket · bar · lounge	**Table-type** pocha · hof · izakaya · grill
Inside 14	① **Event + admission control together** Among the 8 surveyed inside-14 cases, entry-type lounges/clubs ran the biggest events. Attach capacity cap, evac route, and ID check.	② **One item giveaway per costumed table** One dedicated ID checker. No menu overhaul.
Outside 14	③ **Pick Fri or Sat for one ticketed night, sell in advance** 2026 announcements split into Sat-only, Fri-Sat, and 1-week+. Pick one night to lean on and pre-sell tickets.	④ **Props tier-1 + one item giveaway** Keep stock at a normal-Saturday level. Just create one photo-worthy spot.

HOW TO READ

The 14 zones are Seoul's 2025 Halloween crowd-density areas (p.04). Inside, 'management' comes first; outside, 'date choice' does. Per-cell do's and don'ts are on p.10.

Sources: Sewang AI Center bar survey, 25 cases (2026.10.18, addresses verified on KakaoMap) / Seoul City 2025.10.24. Sales impact unverified — read as behavioral differences only. ※ Family/café districts (Yongin Bojeong-dong, Gwanggyo) are daytime trade, out of scope.

14

Streets are managed — 14 zones

Seoul's 2025 Halloween crowd-density zones. The 8 highlighted are priority.

Itaewon · **Hongdae** · **Seongsu** · **Konkuk Univ.** · **Gangnam Stn.** · **Apgujeong** · **Myeongdong** · **Ikseon-dong** · Wangsimni · Sinchon · Balsan · Sillim · Sharosu-gil · Nonhyeon

11만 명

Hongdae tourism-zone peak crowd

Saturday 1-week-before Halloween (2025.10.25), Mapo-gu tally

4,922명

Police special-task deployed personnel

Same weekend, Seoul Halloween special measures

At 'severe congestion' the subway may skip stops; entrance separation and traffic control apply — **guest access and delivery vehicle entry can be blocked.** If you're inside the 14, check same-day traffic control in advance.

RISK CARD · SHIBUYA

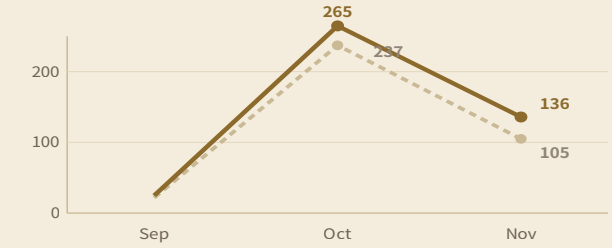
Tokyo's Shibuya — also a Saturday Halloween this year — banned street drinking (17:00–05:00) and **asked nearby shops to refrain from selling alcohol** (reported 2026.10.2). Street controls can spill over into on-premise sales — check same-day municipal notices on 10/31.

Sources: Seoul Metropolitan Government (2025 Halloween crowd-density zones · traffic control · entrance separation · subway skip review) / Seoul Shinmun 2025.10.27 (Hongdae 110K · police 4,922) / Hankyung TV 2026.10.2 (Shibuya). Crowd figures are double-wide intervals with uncertainty.

Insta 'Halloween' mentions run into November

Insta 'Halloween' posts normalized to **beer mentions=100**, two years overlaid. 2024 Halloween fell on Thursday, 2025 on Friday.

Instagram 'Halloween' ÷ 'beer' ×100 · Sep–Nov · 2024 vs 2025



23% → 30%

Nov share of posts (Oct+Nov)

2024 23.2% → 2025 30.3%

+29%

Nov mentions vs beer

105 → 136. Oct 237 → 265 (+12%)

HOW TO READ

Nov posts +29% vs beer — Halloween spilled into November (possibly delayed review posts; weekday effect not asserted). **This year is Saturday: peak Fri+Sat, Sunday for cleanup.**

Source: Instagram Graph API hashtag search (top media), Oct 1–Nov 30, weekly snapshots 2026.10.18. Absolute Oct 75,443 → 111,965 (+48%), beer +33% — annual collection volume varies so we use ratios. 2024 Oct–Nov saw a sharp beer-collection drop, so ±10% matching Sunday 2024 drop could be overstated (collection incomplete).

STORE · 25 ACTUAL BARS

25

25 bars did this

Based on Oct 2025 posts/blogs (incl. 2023–24 and 2026 announcements). Addresses verified on KakaoMap; items missing from posts marked 'unverified'.

12/25

Ran costume-table perks

Item giveaway 5 · Contest/ award 4 · Surprise gift 1 · % discount 1 (10%) · unverified 1

3/25

Limited menu / package

All-you-can packages 2 · Limited food/wine 1. Bars that newly created a limited drink: 0

4 places

Whole-venue themed deco

Photo zone/props 3 · unverified 18 — judged only on photo/ caption-confirmed bars

6 · 6 · 4

Event duration: day-of · 2–3 days · 1 week+

Unverified 9. 2026 announcements (7): Sat-only 2 · Fri–Sat 2 · 1-week+ 2 · unverified 1

HOW TO READ

In this sample, **item giveaways** (one shot · one main dish · one soju bottle · one side · stickers) and % discounts looked comparable — small-table bars went item-based, ticket/all-you-can venues went discount/package. Unverified-address bars include 20–30% discount cases.

Caveat: 25 bars (22 brands) · Inside-14 8 · Seoul outside-14 4 · Southern Gyeonggi 13 (Suwon/Seongnam-weighted search, includes bias). Sales impact all unverified.

Source: Sewang AI Center bar survey (2026.10.18) — 5 Naver blog full reads + Insta/Threads/Daangn post search summaries + KakaoMap address verification across 25 bars. No phone or site visits.

MENU · DRINK ANGLE

Don't invent — just change the drink's color

Three menu plays. ①② from our 25-bar survey, ③ reference cases outside the sample. No bar names — described as **district + type**.

① Item giveaway

- One main dish per costumed table Sharosu-gil pocha · 2025
- One tequila shot Euljiro solo bar · 2025·2026
- One soju bottle per table Osan pocha · 2023
- One side dish Yeonnam izakaya · 2026 announcement

② Package

- ₩79,000 all-you-can whisky+wine Haebangchon gastro-bar · 2025
- 3-hour all-you-can drink ticket Hongdae cocktail bar · 2026 announcement, "sold out last year" per bar's own note
- Order-linked wine service + costume discount Pangyo pub · 2026 announcement

③ Color swap

- Hibiscus/blue-lime drinks, skull-glass highball Hongdae concept restaurant · 2024 blog, address unverified
- Purple limited menu Jeonju café · 2025, non-alcohol reference

HOW TO READ

None of the 25 bars created a new limited drink. **Just change color and glass on one existing**

highball — enough. Item giveaways must be fixed to 'one' for clean math.

※ Prices/quantities on 2026 announcements may change — omitted. % discounts only after P&L math (p.10).

Source: Sewang AI Center bar survey (2026.10.18) — Naver blog full reads 2025.10.24·2024.11.4, Threads/Insta post search summaries / ELLE 2025.10.10 (café).

INTERIOR · ANGLE

3 tiers — just one photo spot

Three tiers by investment. **The minimum investment that still generates guest photos is tier-2** — one entrance photo zone.

Tier 1 — **Props**

Free costume stickers at the counter — Suwon bar 2024. Add pumpkins to existing deco for 'photo-zone vibe' — Gaebong izakaya 2025 (sponsored review).

Tier 2 — **Entrance photo-zone swap**

Replace the permanent entrance photo zone with a Halloween version — Suwon hof 2025 (this bar also added staff costumes to reach tier-3, but the photo spot works with the swap alone).

Tier 3 — **Whole-venue theme**

In-house "Hero vs Villain" theme across 3 zones, two years running — Itaewon lounge 2025. Highest cost and labor.

CAUTION · CHARACTER THEMES

Three Suwon bars (one address unverified) used anime IP themes (Demon Slayer, Attack on Titan), and Google's 2025 top-5 costume searches were K-pop demon-hunter related (2026 unknown). But **responsibility for commercial use of character trademarks/images lies with the bar.** This report does not recommend it.

Get consent before posting guest photos; staff costumes are the bar's expense.

Source: Sewang AI Center bar survey (2026.10.18) — Naver blog full reads 2025.10.27·10.29·11.3, Insta post search summaries / Electronic Times 2025.10.30 (top-5 costume searches).

OPERATION · ANGLE

Fri+Sat two days — and the Saturday trap

FRI	SAT · Halloween	SUN
10.30	**10.31**	**11.1**
Costumed guests from evening. Finish orders and supplies before today.	Early open through extended close. One dedicated ID checker.	Cleanup. 11/2 Mon workday — not a peak.

The 7 announced 2026 bars split **Sat-only 2 · Fri–Sat 2 · 1-week+ 2 · unverified 1**. Advance bookings closed a week early in one case (2024 blogger record).

a Saturday is already peak revenue

The Halloween uplift can be smaller than on a weekday Halloween. Mixing costumed guests with group guests slows table turnover.

b Sunday is not a peak

11/2 Mon is a workday. Extend Sunday only after labor-cost math.

c Inside-14 means traffic control

Deliveries and guest access can be restricted. Check same-day control radius in advance.

d Last outdoor-seat weekend

Overlaps the end of outdoor-seat season (W37). Build in weather buffer.

Source: Sewang AI Center bar survey (2026.10.18) — 2026 announcement 7-bar Insta post search summaries, Naver blog 2024.11.4 / Seoul City 2025.10.24 (traffic control, entrance separation) / Liquor Trends W37 (outdoor-seat season).

Checklist by cell

COMMON · ALL 4 CELLS

◯ One dedicated door-ID checker — no exception for costumed guests
◯ Finish orders and supplies (ice, soda, glassware) before Friday

① Inside-14 · Entry

◯ Capacity cap · evac route · keep-right guidance (bar version of MOIS public advisory)
◯ Run contests alongside admission control
✕ Street soliciting · outdoor tables

② Inside-14 · Table

◯ One item giveaway per costumed table
◯ Verify same-day traffic control and delivery times
✕ Menu overhaul

③ Outside-14 · Entry

◯ Fri or Sat one-ticket night, pre-sell
◯ Contest / award
✕ Un-math'd % discount

④ Outside-14 · Table

◯ Props tier-1 + one item giveaway
◯ Normal-Saturday stock

※ MOIS 2025 advisory: avoid peak hours · check entrances/evac routes · safe distance · one-way keep-right. The same principles apply inside the bar.

Source: p.03 decision table / Sewang AI Center bar survey (2026.10.18) / Seoul Economy 2025.10.29 (MOIS special safety management 10/24–11/2, public advisory).

Three things to apply this week

01 Decision table first, date second

If inside 14, run events but attach capacity, evac routes, and ID checks. If outside, **pick which night, Fri or Sat, to lean on** first. Sunday is cleanup.

02 Keep perks to one item

Across 12 surveyed: item giveaway 5 · contest 4 · % discount 1. Pick **one item** — one main dish, one shot, one soju bottle — and the math stays simple. Don't invent a limited drink; just change color and glass on one highball.

03 Interior: just one photo spot

Swap the entrance photo zone to a Halloween version. Start props with stickers and pumpkins. Character themes carry trademark/copyright liability on the bar. Get consent before posting guest photos; staff costumes are the bar's expense.

ORDER MEMO · before 10/30 (Fri)

Last delivery day _____ (confirm with your rep)

Non-alcohol supplies: ice · soda · glassware — prep at normal-Saturday level

Inside-14 bars: 10/31 same-day traffic control and delivery availability — ask your rep

All of this is "district- and format-dependent" — start with the decision table on p. 03. For draft-beer certification and orders, ask your rep.

Sources

Article figures are as of the reporting date. 'Actuals' are figures Sewang AI Center built from public posts on 2026.10.18 — not official statistics.

01 Seoul Media Hub 2025.10.24 "Halloween special safety plan…14 crowd-density zones under focused management" — 14 zones · priority 8 · 10/24–11/2 · subway skip-review · entrance separation

02 Seoul Shinmun 2025.10.27 — 10/25 Hongdae tourism-zone peak 110K (Mapo-gu), police special-task 4,922

03 Seoul Economy 2025.10.29 "Halloween safety-plan review meeting" — MOIS special safety 10/24–11/2, first 'caution' alert level, public advisory

04 Ajeu 2025.10.19 "K-retail's October special gone" — Big-3 dept stores and hypermarts skipped Halloween promos; among CVS, only CU ran online

05 Hankyung TV 2026.10.2 "Walls up, 'don't sell booze'…Halloween hotspot in the end" — Shibuya street-drinking ban, shops asked to refrain from alcohol sales

06 Electronic Times 2025.10.30 — 2025 Google Halloween costume search top-5 (K-pop demon-hunter)

07 ELLE 2025.10.10 · 10.27 — café/theme-park Halloween limited menus and deco (non-alcohol reference)

08 Sometrend Instagram monthly mentions — Halloween spellings / beer / Halloween costume, 2024.9–2026.10, collected 2026.10.18

09 Actuals · 25-bar survey — 5 Naver blog full reads, ~60 Insta/Threads/Facebook/Daangn post search summaries, KakaoMap address verification. No phone or site visits

10 Calendar — 10/31 weekday (2015·2020·2026 Sat, 2024 Thu, 2025 Fri)

11 Liquor Trends W35 (Chuseok decision-table format) · W37 (outdoor-seat season) · W42 (solo bars)

SECOND CROSS-CHECK

Body figures were re-matched against the data appendix. Insta/Threads bodies were inaccessible

so only search summaries were used; items where numbers were cut off are marked 'unverified'.

※ Bars in this report are described only as 'district + type', without names. Bar cases reflect notices at posting time; actual execution and results were not verified.

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NEXT ISSUE

Published 11/4 (Wed). For 10/31 orders and delivery, contact your rep.

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